QP CODE- 25901878

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-BVOC (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION April 2026 second SEMESTER

Skill Development Components (SDC) - MG2SDCTAH100 - CULTURAL HERITAGE OF INDIA TOURISM INFRASTRUCTURE & PLANNING

(2025 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Answer in one or two sentences ,Answer any 10 questions

Each question carries 2 marks.

1. What is the role of culture in tourism? [U] / [CO1]

   Culture plays a vital role in tourism as it attracts visitors through traditions, heritage, art, festivals, and lifestyle of a destination. It helps promote local identity and enhances the tourist experience while supporting cultural preservation.

2. What is live performance? [U] / [CO1]

   A live performance is an event where artists perform in front of an audience in real time, such as music, dance, theatre, or drama, without pre-recording.

3. What are major tourism policies in India? [U] / [CO3]

   Major tourism policies in India include the National Tourism Policy**,** Incredible India Campaign, and Swadesh Darshan Scheme, which focus on promoting tourism, developing infrastructure, and enhancing the country’s image as a tourist destination.

4. What is the role of communication infrastructure in tourism? [U] / [CO4]

   Communication infrastructure plays a key role in tourism by enabling easy access to information, bookings, and navigation through internet, mobile networks, and media. It improves tourist convenience, safety, and overall travel experience.

5. What is demand forecasting? [U] / [CO3]

   Demand forecasting is the process of predicting future tourist demand based on past data, trends, and market analysis to help in planning and decision-making in tourism.

6. What is excavation? [An] / [CO2]

   Excavation is the process of carefully digging and removing soil or earth to uncover buried objects, structures, or archaeological remains.

7. Define Indian music. [U] / [CO1]

   Indian music is the traditional musical system of India, characterized by melody (*raga*), rhythm (*tala*), and improvisation, encompassing both classical and folk styles.

8. What is rail transport? [U] / [CO4]

   Rail transport is a mode of transportation that carries passengers and goods on trains running on railway tracks.

9. What is modern architecture? [An] / [CO2]

   Modern architecture is a style of building that emphasizes simplicity, functionality, and the use of new materials like steel, glass, and concrete, with minimal ornamentation.

10. Define folk dance. [U] / [CO1]

    Folk dance is a traditional dance form performed by local communities, reflecting their culture, customs, and social life, usually passed down through generations.

11. What is physical carrying capacity? [U] / [CO3]

    Physical carrying capacity is the maximum number of people that a tourist destination can accommodate at a given time without causing physical damage or overcrowding.

12. What is meant by attraction in tourism? [U] / [CO3]

    An attraction in tourism is any natural, cultural, or man-made feature that draws visitors to a destination, such as landscapes, monuments, festivals, or events.

[2x10 = 20]

Part B

Short Essay- Answer any 6 questions

Each question carries 5 marks

13. Discuss regional diversity in Indian crafts. [U] / [CO1]

Regional diversity in Indian crafts reflects the vast cultural, climatic, and historical variations across different parts of India. Each region has developed its own distinctive styles, materials, techniques, and artistic expressions based on local traditions and resources.

1. North India

Crafts here are often influenced by royal patronage and Mughal aesthetics.

- Kashmir: Famous for Pashmina shawls, papier-mâché, and wood carving.
- Punjab & Uttar Pradesh: Phulkari embroidery and zari-zardozi work.
- Rajasthan: Known for block printing, blue pottery, and miniature paintings.

2. South India

South Indian crafts are deeply connected with temple culture and traditional rituals.

- Tamil Nadu: Bronze sculptures (Chola style) and Tanjore paintings.
- Kerala: Coir products, mural paintings, and wood carvings.
- Karnataka: Sandalwood carving and Mysore silk.

3. East India

This region emphasizes tribal art and natural materials.

- West Bengal: Terracotta, Kantha embroidery, and Dokra metal crafts.
- Odisha: Pattachitra paintings and stone carving.
- Bihar: Madhubani paintings with mythological themes.

4. West India

Crafts here are vibrant, colorful, and often linked to desert life and trade.

- Gujarat: Bandhani tie-dye, mirror work, and embroidery.
- Maharashtra: Warli tribal paintings and Kolhapuri crafts.
- Goa: Coconut shell crafts and lacework.

5. North-East India

Crafts are eco-friendly and use locally available materials like bamboo and cane.

- Assam: Silk weaving (Muga and Eri silk).
- Nagaland & Manipur: Tribal jewelry, shawls, and basketry.

Key Features of Regional Diversity

- Use of local materials: Clay, bamboo, silk, wool, metal, etc.
- Cultural influence: Religion, festivals, and traditions shape designs.
- Climate impact: Availability of raw materials affects craft styles.
- Community identity: Crafts reflect the lifestyle of tribes and communities.

14. Describe the criteria for World Heritage listing. [An] / [CO2]

Cultural Criteria (i – vi)

These apply to cultural heritage such as monuments, cities, and artistic works:

1. **(i) Masterpiece of human creative genius**
    - Example: Taj Mahal
2. **(ii) Interchange of human values**
    - Shows cultural exchange over time (architecture, technology, art)
3. **(iii) Unique testimony to a cultural tradition or civilization**
    - Represents living or extinct cultures
4. **(iv) Outstanding example of a type of building or landscape**
    - Illustrates important historical stages
5. **(v) Traditional human settlement or land use**
    - Reflects interaction between humans and environment
6. **(vi) Association with events, ideas, or beliefs of global significance**
    - Linked to religion, literature, or history

Natural Criteria (vii – x)

These apply to natural heritage like landscapes, ecosystems, and biodiversity:

7. **(vii) Exceptional natural beauty or aesthetic importance**
    - Example: Great Barrier Reef
8. **(viii) Outstanding geological or earth history features**
    - Fossils, landforms, tectonic processes
9. **(ix) Ecological and biological processes**
    - Ongoing natural processes in ecosystems
10. **(x) Biodiversity conservation**

- Important habitats for endangered species

15. Analyse the role of NGOs in promoting responsible tourism awareness. [An] / [CO3]

1. Awareness and Education

NGOs design campaigns to educate both tourists and local communities about responsible behavior.

- Promote eco-friendly practices (waste reduction, water conservation)
- Encourage respect for local culture and traditions
- Conduct workshops, seminars, and training programs

Example: NGOs often align with global initiatives like UNESCO to raise awareness about protecting heritage sites.

2. Community Empowerment

NGOs help local communities actively participate in tourism.

- Train locals in hospitality, guiding, and handicrafts
- Promote community-based tourism (CBT)
- Ensure fair distribution of tourism income

This reduces exploitation and strengthens local economies.

3. Environmental Conservation

A major role of NGOs is protecting natural resources affected by tourism.

- Organize clean-up drives and conservation programs
- Advocate for sustainable use of forests, wildlife, and water
- Monitor environmental impacts of tourism

For instance, NGOs working in areas like Periyar National Park promote eco-tourism practices.

4. Policy Advocacy and Monitoring

NGOs influence tourism policies and ensure accountability.

- Lobby governments for sustainable tourism policies
- Monitor implementation of environmental laws
- Act as watchdogs against unethical tourism practices

They often collaborate with organizations like World Wide Fund for Nature.

5. Promotion of Ethical Practices

NGOs encourage responsible behavior among tourism stakeholders.

- Advocate against child labor, wildlife exploitation, and cultural commodification
- Promote ethical tour operations and fair trade tourism
- Certify eco-friendly tourism businesses

6. Research and Documentation

NGOs conduct studies to understand tourism impacts.

- Publish reports on sustainability and carrying capacity
- Provide data for better planning and decision-making
- Highlight best practices and success stories

7. Collaboration and Partnerships

NGOs work with governments, private sectors, and international bodies.

- Develop sustainable tourism models
- Implement joint awareness campaigns
- Share global best practices at the local level

16. Apply the concept of health services in maintaining safe tourist destinations. [A] / [CO3]

1. Preventive Health Services

These reduce health risks before they occur:

- Vaccination programs for locals and travelers
- Health awareness campaigns (hygiene, food safety, sanitation)
- Monitoring communicable diseases

Example: After experiences like COVID-19, destinations now prioritize preventive protocols such as masking, sanitation, and screening.

2. Curative Health Services

These ensure timely treatment when tourists fall ill or face emergencies:

- Availability of hospitals, clinics, and first-aid centers
- Emergency medical response systems (ambulances, helplines)
- Multilingual medical assistance for international tourists

Quick and efficient care builds trust among visitors.

3. Infrastructure and Sanitation

Safe destinations require proper health-related infrastructure:

- Clean drinking water supply
- Hygienic accommodation and food services
- Waste management and sewage systems

For example, tourist-heavy regions like Kochi maintain sanitation standards to protect both residents and visitors.

4. Health Regulations and Standards

Governments enforce rules to maintain safety:

- Regular inspection of hotels, restaurants, and transport
- Licensing and certification of tourism establishments
- Food safety regulations

These measures prevent outbreaks and ensure quality service.

5. Emergency Preparedness and Crisis Management

Health services must be prepared for unexpected situations:

- Disaster response systems (natural calamities, accidents)
- Quarantine facilities and isolation wards
- Coordination between health and tourism departments

This is crucial in managing crises and minimizing risks.

6. Traveler Health Information Services

Providing accurate information helps tourists stay safe:

- Travel advisories and vaccination requirements
- Information on local health risks and precautions
- Digital health apps and helplines

7. Collaboration with Tourism Sector

Health services must work with tourism stakeholders:

- Training hotel staff in first aid and hygiene
- Implementing safety protocols in transport and attractions
- Promoting “safe tourism” certifications

17. Analyse the relationship between tourism development and environmental degradation. [An] / [CO3]

1. Negative Impacts of Tourism Development

a) Overuse of Natural Resources

Rapid tourism growth increases demand for water, energy, and land. In destinations like Goa Beaches, excessive tourist inflow leads to water shortages and pressure on local resources.

b) Pollution

- Air pollution from transport (flights, vehicles)
- Water pollution from sewage and waste disposal
- Noise pollution in crowded tourist spots

For example, backwater tourism in Alappuzha has faced challenges due to waste and fuel discharge from houseboats.

c) Habitat Destruction and Biodiversity Loss

Construction of hotels, resorts, and infrastructure leads to deforestation and loss of wildlife habitats. Sensitive ecosystems like Himalayan Region are particularly vulnerable.

d) Overcrowding (Overtourism)

Excessive tourist numbers exceed the carrying capacity of destinations, causing environmental stress, erosion, and degradation of natural attractions.

2. Positive Impacts of Tourism Development

a) Conservation and Protection

Tourism can generate funds for environmental protection. Areas like Periyar National Park use tourism revenue for wildlife conservation and park management.

b) Environmental Awareness

Tourism promotes awareness among visitors and locals about the importance of protecting nature and biodiversity.

c) Sustainable Infrastructure Development

Eco-friendly tourism encourages:

- Renewable energy use
- Waste management systems
- Eco-lodges and green buildings

d) Community Participation

Local communities become stakeholders in conservation through eco-tourism and community-based tourism initiatives.

3. Key Factors Influencing the Relationship

- Planning and policy: Lack of regulation increases degradation
- Carrying capacity management: Controlling tourist numbers
- Type of tourism: Mass tourism vs. sustainable tourism
- Awareness and behavior: Responsible tourist practices

4. Balancing Tourism and Environment

To reduce environmental degradation:

- Promote sustainable and eco-tourism
- Enforce strict environmental laws
- Encourage responsible tourist behavior
- Use scientific tools like Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA)

18. Describe the basics of Ayurveda. [U] / [CO1]

Ayurveda is one of the world's oldest holistic healing systems, developed in India over 3,000 years ago. The term comes from Sanskrit—"Ayur" (life) and "Veda" (knowledge)—meaning *"the science of life."* It focuses on maintaining health through balance in body, mind, and spirit.

1. Fundamental Principles

a) Panchamahabhutas (Five Elements)

Ayurveda believes everything in the universe, including the human body, is made of five elements:

- Earth (Prithvi)
- Water (Jala)
- Fire (Agni)
- Air (Vayu)
- Space (Akasha)

b) Tridosha Theory

Health depends on the balance of three biological energies called Doshas:

- Vata (air + space): controls movement and nervous system
- Pitta (fire + water): controls digestion and metabolism
- Kapha (earth + water): provides structure and stability

Each individual has a unique combination of these doshas.

c) Prakriti (Body Constitution)

- Refers to a person's natural physical and mental constitution
- Determines susceptibility to diseases and lifestyle needs

2. Concept of Health

According to Ayurveda, good health means:

- Balance of doshas
- Proper digestion (Agni)
- Healthy tissues (Dhatus)
- Proper elimination of waste (Malas)
- Mental and spiritual well-being

3. Diagnosis in Ayurveda

Diagnosis is based on:

- Observation (appearance, behavior)
- Pulse examination (Nadi Pariksha)
- Assessment of digestion, lifestyle, and habits

4. Treatment Methods

a) Herbal Medicine

Use of natural herbs, oils, and plant-based remedies.

b) Panchakarma Therapy

A detoxification process to remove toxins:

- Vamana (emesis)
- Virechana (purgation)
- Basti (enema)
- Nasya (nasal therapy)
- Raktamokshana (blood purification)

c) Diet and Lifestyle (Ahara & Vihara)

- Balanced diet based on dosha
- Daily routine (Dinacharya) and seasonal routine (Ritucharya)

d) Yoga and Meditation

Ayurveda integrates practices like Yoga to promote physical and mental balance.

5. Preventive Approach

Ayurveda emphasizes prevention rather than cure:

- Healthy eating habits
- Regular detoxification
- Stress management
- Harmony with nature

19. Why is risk sharing important in PPP? [An] / [CO4]

Risk sharing is a core principle of Public–Private Partnerships (PPP) because it determines whether a project is efficient, financially viable, and sustainable. In a PPP, risks are allocated between the public sector and private sector in a way that each party handles the risks it is best equipped to manage.

1. Improves Project Efficiency

When risks are properly shared:

- The private sector manages construction, operational, and financial risks efficiently
- The government handles regulatory and policy-related risks
  This leads to better planning, cost control, and timely completion.

2. Reduces Financial Burden on Government

Risk sharing prevents the government from bearing all uncertainties:

- Private partners invest capital and take on commercial risks
- This reduces public expenditure and fiscal pressure

3. Encourages Private Sector Participation

Private investors are more willing to participate when:

- Risks are clearly defined and fairly allocated
- They are not burdened with uncontrollable risks (e.g., political or legal changes)

Balanced risk sharing increases investor confidence.

4. Ensures Better Risk Management

Each risk is assigned to the party best able to manage it:

- Construction risk → Private sector
- Policy/regulatory risk → Government
- Demand risk → Shared or allocated based on agreement

This leads to more effective mitigation strategies.

5. Enhances Value for Money

Efficient risk allocation ensures:

- Lower project costs over time
- Better quality services
- Optimal use of resources

Ultimately, the public gets better value from infrastructure projects.

6. Promotes Accountability

Clearly defined risks create accountability:

- Private partners are responsible for performance
- Governments ensure compliance and public interest

7. Improves Project Sustainability

Proper risk sharing:

- Minimizes project failures
- Ensures long-term operation and maintenance
- Protects both parties from major losses

20. Describe types of museums. [An] / [CO2]

Museums can be classified into different types based on their collections, purpose, and audience. Each type preserves and presents specific aspects of heritage, knowledge, and culture.

1. Art Museums

These museums display paintings, sculptures, and visual arts.

- Focus on aesthetic and creative expression
- Example: National Gallery of Modern Art

2. History Museums

They preserve historical objects and narrate past events.

- Include artifacts, documents, and exhibits on civilizations
- Example: Indian Museum

3. Archaeological Museums

Dedicated to ancient artifacts recovered through excavations.

- Display tools, pottery, sculptures, and ruins
- Help understand early human life and cultures

4. Science and Technology Museums

Focus on scientific discoveries and innovations.

- Interactive exhibits and demonstrations
- Promote learning through experiments

5. Natural History Museums

These museums showcase nature and biodiversity.

- Include fossils, plants, animals, and ecosystems
- Educate about environmental conservation

6. Ethnographic (Anthropological) Museums

Highlight cultures, traditions, and lifestyles of different communities.

- Display costumes, tools, rituals, and crafts
- Emphasize cultural diversity

7. Specialized Museums

Focused on a specific subject or theme:

- Transport museums
- Maritime museums
- Textile museums
- Defense or war museums

8. Open-Air Museums

- Exhibits are displayed outdoors
- Include historic buildings, villages, and landscapes
- Provide a real-life experience of past lifestyles

9. Children's Museums

Designed for young audiences:

- Interactive and educational exhibits
- Encourage learning through play and activities

10. Virtual Museums

Digital museums accessible online:

- Use technology to display collections
- Allow global access without physical presence

[5x6 = 30]

Part C

Essay- Answer any 2 questions

Each question carries 10 marks

21. Explain the role of classical dance in promoting cultural tourism. [U] / [CO1]

Classical dance plays a powerful role in promoting cultural tourism by showcasing a destination's heritage, traditions, and artistic identity. In India, classical dances are not just performances—they are living expressions of history, religion, and regional culture that attract tourists from around the world.

1. Showcasing Cultural Heritage

Classical dance forms reflect ancient traditions, mythology, and spiritual beliefs.

- Dances like Bharatanatyam and Kathakali narrate stories from epics such as the Ramayana and Mahabharata.
- Tourists gain insight into local customs and values through performances.

2. Enhancing Tourist Experience

Live dance performances enrich the travel experience by:

- Providing authentic cultural entertainment
- Offering immersive storytelling through music, costume, and expressions
- Creating memorable experiences for visitors

Destinations like Thiruvananthapuram regularly host cultural shows for tourists.

3. Supporting Local Economy

Classical dance contributes to economic development:

- Generates employment for dancers, musicians, and artisans
- Encourages sale of traditional costumes, jewelry, and handicrafts
- Boosts revenue through cultural festivals and events

4. Promoting Cultural Festivals and Events

Dance is a key attraction in festivals:

- Events like Khajuraho Dance Festival attract international tourists
- Such festivals showcase multiple dance forms in heritage settings

5. Preservation of Traditions

Tourism encourages the survival of classical dance forms:

- Increased demand leads to training institutions and performances
- Younger generations are motivated to learn and continue traditions

6. Strengthening Destination Branding

Classical dance helps create a unique identity for destinations:

- Kerala is associated with Kathakali and Mohiniyattam
- Tamil Nadu is known for Bharatanatyam

This cultural branding enhances global recognition.

7. Cultural Exchange and Global Awareness

- Tourists learn about Indian culture through performances
- International collaborations and tours promote cross-cultural understanding

22. Evaluate the role of monuments in promoting heritage tourism. [An] / [CO2]

Monuments are central to heritage tourism because they embody a region's history, architecture, and cultural identity. Their role goes beyond sightseeing—they function as cultural symbols, educational resources, and economic drivers.

1. Preservation of History and Culture

Monuments act as tangible links to the past:

- They preserve art, architecture, and historical narratives
- Reflect the lifestyle, beliefs, and achievements of earlier civilizations

For example, the Taj Mahal represents Mughal architecture and love symbolism, attracting global attention.

2. Major Tourist Attractions

Monuments are often the primary motivation for travel:

- Iconic sites draw both domestic and international tourists
- They enhance the appeal and identity of destinations

Sites like Qutub Minar and Hampi significantly boost tourist inflow.

3. Economic Contribution

Monuments generate substantial economic benefits:

- Revenue through entry fees, guided tours, and related services
- Creation of jobs in tourism, hospitality, and local crafts

Heritage tourism around monuments supports local economies.

4. Educational and Research Value

- Provide learning opportunities about history, art, and architecture
- Serve as sites for academic research and cultural studies
- Enhance awareness among tourists and students

5. Promotion of Cultural Identity

Monuments strengthen national and regional pride:

- Act as symbols of identity and heritage
- Promote cultural continuity and awareness

6. Encouraging Conservation and Awareness

Tourism creates incentives to preserve monuments:

- Government and organizations invest in restoration and maintenance
- Global recognition through bodies like UNESCO

7. Destination Branding and Global Recognition

- Monuments help build a strong international image
- World-famous heritage sites attract global tourism markets

8. Challenges and Critical Evaluation

While beneficial, monuments also face issues:

- Overtourism leading to wear and tear
- Environmental degradation and pollution
- Need for proper management and visitor control

23. Assess government initiatives in destination development. [E] / [CO4]

Government initiatives play a decisive role in destination development by shaping infrastructure, policy, marketing, and sustainability. In India, multiple programs illustrate how public intervention can transform destinations into competitive tourism products.

1. Infrastructure Development

Governments invest in core and tourist-specific infrastructure:

- Roads, airports, rail connectivity, and urban amenities
- Tourist facilities such as signage, information centers, sanitation

Example: The UDAN Scheme improves air connectivity to smaller destinations, making them accessible to tourists.

2. Thematic and Integrated Development

Programs focus on developing destinations around themes:

- Spiritual, coastal, heritage, eco-tourism circuits

Example: Swadesh Darshan Scheme develops integrated tourist circuits with better facilities.

3. Pilgrimage and Heritage Development

Focused initiatives improve religious and heritage sites:

- Infrastructure, crowd management, and amenities

Example: PRASHAD Scheme enhances pilgrimage destinations.

4. Promotion and Marketing

Governments promote destinations globally:

- Branding campaigns, digital marketing, and international events

Example: Incredible India showcases India's cultural and natural diversity.

5. Sustainable Tourism Initiatives

Focus on eco-friendly and responsible tourism:

- Conservation of natural and cultural resources
- Promotion of eco-tourism and community participation

Example: Ministry of Tourism India promotes sustainable practices and guidelines.

6. Skill Development and Employment

Training programs for tourism stakeholders:

- Hospitality training, guides, and local entrepreneurship

7. Public–Private Partnerships (PPP)

Government collaborates with private sector:

- Development of hotels, resorts, and attractions
- Efficient project execution and innovation

8. Digital and Smart Tourism Initiatives

- Online booking systems, mobile apps, smart destination management
- Use of GIS and data analytics

[10x2 = 20]